QUICK GUIDE

LONG OR SHORT BLEND

What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

WHAT IT IS

Blend length is how long two tracks play together. Long blends suit dense, compatible grooves with sparse intros. Short blends and cuts suit clashing vocals, different genres or a sudden change of energy.

WHAT YOU'LL NOTICE

Deliberate. The transition fits the two tracks instead of following a habit.



01

ENERGY AND KEY

Do they fit? Is the energy going up, flat or down?

02

VOCALS AND MELODY

If both tracks have a hook in the overlap, shorten the blend.

03

WHAT'S COMING NEXT

Check the next breakdown or drop before you commit.

DO THIS TONIGHT

Mix the same two tracks three ways and keep the version the pair survives.

- [ ] Try a long blend, 16 to 32 bars.
- [ ] Try a short blend of about 8 bars, then a one-bar cut.
- [ ] Record all three and pick the cleanest.



PRACTICE & CHECK

LONG OR SHORT BLEND: YOUR TURN

WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- Long blends between same-genre tracks in the same key.
- Short blends when both tracks have a strong vocal.
- A quick cut when you want an energy jolt.

QUICK CHECK

1. What decides the blend length?

2. Two vocal hooks overlap. What do you do?

3. Which blend suits dense, compatible grooves?

Answer key: 1) The two tracks, not habit. 2) Shorten the blend. 3) A long blend.

REMEMBER

Match the blend to the pair.

YOUR NOTES

UP NEXT Half-Time and Double-Time

